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How Long Does Trenchless Sewer Repair Take?

One of the first questions homeowners ask about trenchless sewer repair is simple: how long will my house be out of commission? It is a fair question. A sewer repair means the line is out of service while the work happens, and with traditional excavation that disruption can stretch across many days.

The honest answer is that the timeline depends on your specific pipe, which is why it is confirmed during the inspection and estimate. But the steps are predictable, and understanding them shows where the time actually goes and why trenchless repair is often faster than dig-and-replace.

The Steps That Make Up a Trenchless Timeline

1. Camera Inspection and Diagnosis

Every project starts with an HD sewer camera inspection to locate the damage and confirm the pipe's condition, location, and depth. This visit is also where you get the repair recommendation, the estimate, and the expected timeline for your specific line. The inspection itself is a same-visit diagnostic, not a multi-day study.

2. Pipe Cleaning

Before lining, the pipe is cleaned with hydro jetting, which uses high-pressure water to cut through roots and flush out grease, sludge, and buildup. How long this takes depends on the condition of the line. A pipe with heavy root intrusion or years of accumulation needs more cleaning time than one with light buildup.

3. Liner Installation and Curing

The resin-saturated liner is installed inside the existing pipe and cured in place until it hardens into a new structural liner. Curing is the step people underestimate: the resin needs its full cure

time, and rushing it is not an option. Length and diameter of the lined section affect how long installation and curing take.

4. Final Camera Verification

A follow-up camera pass confirms the liner is properly in place and the line is flowing. After verification, the line returns to service.

[CONFIRM WITH SCOTT: typical total duration for a standard residential lining project, e.g. "For a typical residential line, this whole sequence is often completed in ___."]

What Makes a Project Take Longer

- **Length and depth of the damaged section.** Lining 60 feet of pipe takes longer than lining 15 feet.
- **Pipe condition.** Heavy roots, collapsed sections, or severe buildup add cleaning and prep time, and may change the repair plan.
- **Access.** A convenient cleanout speeds everything up. A line with poor access may need an access point created first.
- **Weather and site conditions.** Curing and site work can be affected by conditions on the day of the job.

The Comparison That Actually Matters: Trenchless vs. Digging

Whatever your trenchless timeline turns out to be, the excavation alternative for the same pipe is almost always longer, because digging adds entire phases that lining skips: trenching along the run, removing the old pipe, backfilling, and then restoring everything the trench went through. Lawn, sprinklers, and concrete repairs often continue long after the plumbing itself is done.

Trenchless repair removes most of that. The work happens inside the existing pipe through existing access points, so when the liner is cured and verified, you are essentially finished. There is no second project waiting in the yard. For the full side-by-side, see Trenchless vs. Traditional Dig Sewer Repair: Pros, Cons, and Costs.

Can You Use Water During the Repair?

Plan for the sewer line to be out of service while the liner is installed and curing, which means limiting water use during the active work. Your technician will tell you the exact window for your project before work begins, so you can plan around it. This is another place trenchless has

the edge: the out-of-service window is tied to lining and curing, not to days of excavation and replacement.

Frequently Asked Questions

Does the inspection happen on a separate day from the repair?

The inspection comes first because the repair plan and estimate depend on what the camera finds. Scheduling after that depends on your line and the chosen repair. You will have the expected timeline in hand before anything is booked.

What part of the process takes the longest?

Usually curing. Cleaning time varies with the pipe's condition, but the liner's cure time is fixed by the materials and cannot be rushed. Build your expectations around the cure, not the install.

Does winter weather delay trenchless repair?

Site conditions can affect scheduling and cure considerations, but trenchless work has a natural advantage in a Colorado winter: there is no open trench to dig through frozen ground and no excavated yard waiting for spring restoration.

How to Get a Real Timeline for Your Line

General articles can only describe the steps. Your actual timeline comes from your actual pipe, and that takes a camera. After an inspection, Alphalete explains the recommended repair method, the expected timeline, and the estimate for your project before any work begins. If you are still researching options, our guide to what trenchless sewer repair is and how it works covers the full process.

Alphalete Trenchless Services provides trenchless sewer repair in Colorado Springs, Denver, and surrounding Colorado communities. Schedule a free video inspection or call (720) 807-3224 to get a timeline for your specific sewer line.